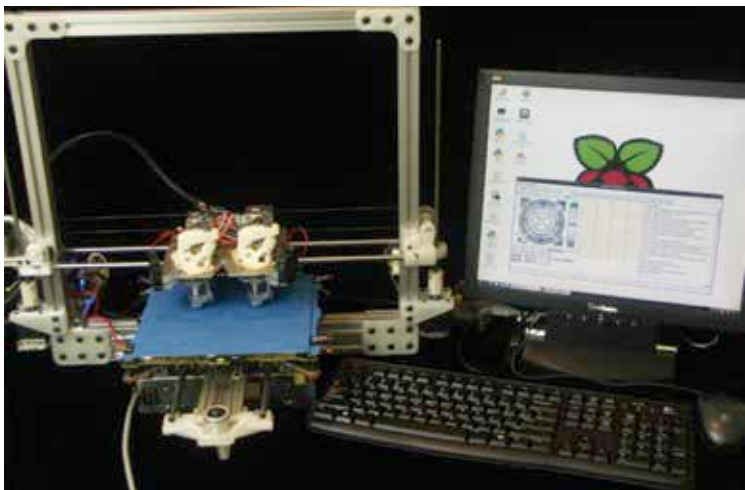




Pi machines can be used to build 3D printer set ups as well.

a laptop or desktop. Both these options were tedious and expensive, but with the Pi they're almost an impulse purchase.

The world of tomorrow in the wake of the Raspberry Pi is going to be one where people have a more direct relationship with their technology. The knowledge of computer programming, coding, building and assembly will be common knowledge to those who wish it to be. Since the cost barrier to entry will be so low, anyone interested in learning about these technologies will be free to do so. The Pi serves to remind people that great and grand projects have human origins and that one imaginative idea only needs some skill and training to become real. Just in the past three years the online community which has thrived around the Raspberry Pi is evidence of this trend.

The biggest change we can expect to see is perhaps in terms of more options. While the Raspberry Foundation seems the best suited body to ensure that costs remain low and that the Pi standard is used throughout, there is nothing wrong in new players such as BeagleBone and others from growing. Growth through competition is one of the defining features of technology and if a new device is able to make the process of using microcomputers better for the users, then everything will change even more radically.

As concurrent technologies like 3D printing and hands-on electrical tinkering becomes more commonplace, the use of microcomputers will shift as well. Today the key purpose of the Pi is to enhance computer literacy by